the airport, Snowden again requested asylum in Russia. In his application, he stated he feared torture and the death penalty if he returned to the United States. He also requested temporary, rather than political, asylum. Under Russian law, temporary asylum requires only the approval of the Russian Federal Migration Service, not President Putin.

US Demands and Russia's Response

Responding to this news, the White House again demanded that Russia expel Snowden. "He should return

A WORRIED DAD

Speaking on Russia's Rossiya-24 television news network, Lon, Snowden's father, expressed his gratitude to Putin for protecting his son. Lon said he did not think his son would receive a fair trial in the United States and Russia was the safest place for him at the moment. Snowden watched his father's interview from the airport. Lon was attempting to arrange a visit to Moscow to cheer up his son.

In an earlier interview with the *Washington Post*, Lon said the FBI had asked him to try to get his son to return. But seeing how US Army Private First Class Chelsea Manning, formerly Bradley, also accused of violating the Espionage Act, had been treated, Lon did not have a high level of trust in the US justice system. Manning was "stripped of his clothes," Lon said on Russian television, "kept for 23 hours a day in solitary confinement, his glasses were removed. That was unacceptable." Addressing his son, he said, "I hope to see you soon. But most of all I want you to be safe. I hope you are watching this. . . . Your family is well. We love you."[7]

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